Where You Are: Care Requirements, the Middle of Step Three

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked, and what comes after it.

Planning ahead for Dad has no deadline, so it helps to know that it has an order. You're on step three of nine, with time in hand.

Below are all nine steps with yours marked, what this part of it produces, and who is involved after it.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

You are here. This step turns what the family has learned into a plain statement of needs. Your part of it, Care Requirements, is the second of its three topics. You finish it with a dated record of the help Dad gets today, the changes the family has agreed are worth raising with a professional, and the questions you'd ask then, with no future arrangement assumed.

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

What this step produces

A dated page about today: the tasks in Dad's week, what he does himself, the help he gets and from whom, and anything his care team has confirmed. Beside it, two short lists: the changes worth a conversation, and the questions you'd ask if one came up. It is the family's record. It isn't an assessment, and it doesn't forecast anything.

It's a record made to be looked at again. The National Institute on Aging's advice about living at home as you age is to be realistic and plan to revisit the decision as your needs change over time. [1]

Your part is done when today's help is written down, the family knows who it would ask for a fresh look, and the changes worth raising are named. No future arrangement needs to be on the page.

What happens next

Care Requirements is the middle of step three's three topics. Needs & Risks comes before it, and Priorities & Recommendations follows. Together the three make up what this step finishes with: the Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap. After that comes the next phase, beginning with the step called Explore Options, whenever the family gets there.

Your record is written to be read by someone qualified to review it. The Family Caregiver Alliance describes one such role, the professional care manager, as usually having a background in counseling, social work or a related health care field and being trained to assess a family's individual situation. That describes the role in general, not any one person. [2]

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: writing down today's help, with dates, and agreeing which changes you'd raise.
- Dad: his own account of his week, and his preferences in his own words.
- His doctor, and any nurse, therapist or pharmacist he sees: the clinical questions, and which changes they'd want to hear about.
- Your care consultant: the part of this step that isn't the family's. That means translating an assessment into the amount and type of help required, weighing home and other arrangements against assessed needs if that question arises, and identifying the supervision, nursing, therapy and changing-care questions that need a clinician's confirmation.

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. In Plan Ahead there's no clock, and a family can stay with this step for as long as it likes.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this part of step three sits and what follows it. The care interview is how the step moves forward: it asks about each area of Dad's daily life in turn and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The advice to revisit a living arrangement as needs change is the National Institute on Aging's. The description of care managers is the Family Caregiver Alliance's, and it describes the role in general.

1. National Institute on Aging, What Is Long-Term Care?
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Caregiving at Home: A Guide to Community Resources